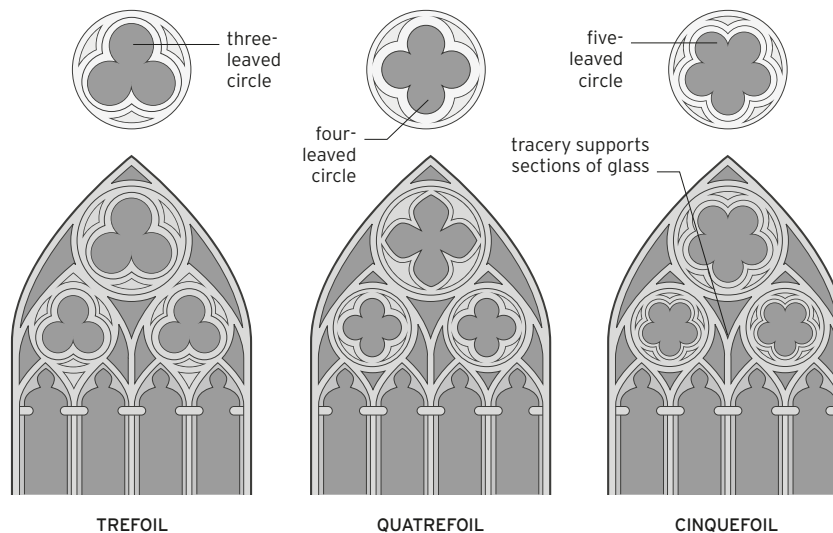


FOIL

Derived from the Latin word *folium*, meaning “leaf,” a foil is a decorative pattern that uses combinations of touching circles to create cloverlike patterns. There are three basic types of foliated decoration: trefoil, quatrefoil, and cinquefoil (respectively, three-, four-, and five-leaved). This type of design is typically seen in the shape of small windows or in the patterned tracery within large windows. It is particularly associated with the Gothic style.



supports the wall of the main building. The forces from the main structure are transmitted across the arch to the pier. *See also* Gothic.

FOIL See panel, above.

FOLLY A generally nonfunctional and whimsical building erected to enhance a landscape.

FORUM An ancient Roman public square or marketplace.

FRAMED BUILDING A building in which the weight is carried by a frame, typically of steel or concrete columns and beams, rather than by load-bearing walls.

FRESCO A type of wall painting executed on freshly laid or wet lime plaster.

FRIEZE In Classical architecture, the wide central part of the entablature, between the architrave (bottom) and cornice (top). The frieze is often decorated, the most famous example being the Parthenon frieze in Athens. In interiors, the frieze is a painted or sculpted section of the wall directly under the cornice or coving. *See also* architrave, Classical, cornice, entablature.

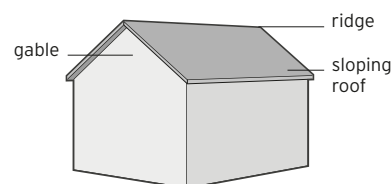
FRONTISPIECE The elements that frame and decorate the main entrance to a building.

FULCRUM The pivot about which a lever turns.

FUNCTIONALISM The principle that buildings should be designed based solely on their purpose and function. This notion took hold following World War I and was part of the greater wave of Modernism. *See also* Modernism.

G

GABLE ▼ The triangular section of wall formed below a pitched roof.



GADROONING A form of sculpted decoration consisting of a series of convex curves, sometimes tapering, sometimes running diagonally. It features on Roman sarcophagi and on metalwork and porcelain.

GALLERY A narrow balcony running the length of the wall overlooking a large interior.

GARBHAGRIHA The innermost sanctum of a Hindu temple, where the idol of the primary deity of the temple is kept.

GARGOYLE A carved imaginary creature, often a grotesque, projecting from the edge of a roof, with a spout for a mouth through which rainwater is directed away from the walls of a building. *See also* Gothic, grotesque.

GAZEBO A small, free-standing pavilion in a garden, constructed to take advantage of a view.

GEOMANCY An age-old belief in the art of reading signs in a landscape to identify beneficial energies. It is similar to the Eastern tradition of feng shui.

GLAZED BRICKS Bricks with a ceramic coating. The coating is often colored, and the bricks are used for decorative effect.

GOPURAM A monumental tower acting as the gateway to a Hindu temple enclosure. *Gopurams* are

typically ornate, covered with painted sculptures.

GOTHIC An architectural style that originated in 12th-century France and flourished throughout Europe during the later part of the Middle Ages (5th to 15th centuries). It is characterized by an emphasis on verticality, with walls reduced to a minimum by high-pointed arches and arcades and expanses of stained-glass windows. It also extensively uses flying buttresses, pinnacles, and spires. Exteriors typically feature a lot of statuary and carvings illustrating Biblical stories and themes for the benefit of illiterate worshippers. *See also* flying buttress, gargoyle, Gothic Revival, grotesque, pinnacle, spire.

GOTHIC REVIVAL A movement in the late 18th and 19th centuries to revive medieval Gothic forms. Some buildings in Gothic style built after medieval times are also referred to as Neo-Gothic.

GREEK CROSS A cross with arms of equal length. *See also* Latin cross.

GREEN BUILDING Construction that is environmentally responsible and resource-efficient.

GRIDIRON PLAN A type of city plan in which streets run at right angles to each other. The most famous example is the street layout of Manhattan.

GROIN VAULT A vault made up of two barrel vaults that intersect at right angles. *See also* rib vault, vault.

GROTESQUE A stone-carved fantastical beast or mythical creature. Grotesques are a common feature of Gothic architecture, decorating the exteriors of predominantly religious buildings.

GROUT A mixture of cement, sand, and water used to seal gaps between tiles or stonework or to repair cracks.